ST.PHILOMENA'S COLLEGE (AUTONOMOUS) MYSORE

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St. Philomena's College: Empowering Minds, Shaping Futures





Most.Rev.Dr.Bernard Moras, Apostolic Administrator, President- MDES

St. Philomena's College is a prestigious institution known for its academic excellence and rich heritage. It is one of the oldest and most reputed colleges in the region, offering a wide range of **undergraduate, postgraduate, and diploma courses in arts, science, commerce, and management.**

A Journey through Time

The history of St. Philomena's College is the story of torchbearers and extraordinary human beings. A Bishop's dream and a Maharaja's munificence culminated in the establishment of St. Philomena's College. **On 24th June 1946**, the Bishop of Mysore, **Rt. Rev. Dr. Rene Feuga**, with other dignitaries, the Bishop vacated his mansion to provide space for classrooms that became the Central Block of the institution and still functions with majesty and grace as the administrative nucleus of the college. The college received its motto, '**Caritas in Scientia**,' meaning '**Love through Knowledge.**

Campus and Infrastructure

St. Philomena's College boasts a beautiful and spacious campus with lush green trees, impressive, historic, and massive buildings, sophisticated infrastructure with state-of-the-art technology, a computerized and well-stocked library, well-equipped and spacious laboratories and classrooms, and separate hostels for boys and girls. It has about ten acres of land exclusively for sports activities, including indoor and outdoor stadiums.

Cultural and Extracurricular Activities

Students are encouraged to participate in various intercollegiate and intra-collegiate competitions to showcase their talents.

The college has exclusive units of Naval and Artillery wings for students interested in joining NCC. It also has a National Service Scheme (NSS) unit that conducts a series of social awareness programs inside and outside the campus.

International Conference MESSAGE

Rev.Dr.Lourdu Prasad Joseph
RECTOR
St. Philomena's College Institutions



It's a tremendous honour for our college to host this extravagant event, providing a fantastic opportunity for our institution and the students of Philomena to gain valuable insights and knowledge from the conference. Scholars and researchers also have a unique chance to learn from renowned global experts, making this a truly enriching experience.



MESSAGE

Dr.Ravi J D SALDANHA
PRINCIPAL
St. Philomena's College Institutions

It is matter of pride to host this 2-days ICRC conference where in more than 150 delegates will participate and present their papers. This conference will benefit the concerned in knowledge, sharing and global unity. All educators, researchers and professionals come together, not just to exchange ideas but to imprint progress and meaningful connections. While congratulating the Department of MCJ for this initiative, we with many more academic events of this kind may be hosted by other departments in the days to come.

Dr. Sukanya,
First and former Head of the Department (HOD),
Journalism and Mass Communication
Former Dean PG studies and Research Centre
St. Philomena's College Institutions

International Conference by the Department of Journalism and Mass Communication, "Reimagining Communication in the 21st Century: Sociological, Political, and Economic Perspectives." 20-21, MARCH -2025

College Hosts International Conference on Imagining Communication in the 21st Century

The Department of Journalism and Research at St. Philomena College (Autonomous) organized an international conference on Imagining Communication in the 21st Century: Sociological, Political, and Economic Perspectives. The event, attended by distinguished academicians, media professionals, and research scholars, explored the evolving dynamics of communication in contemporary society.



The inauguration ceremony was graced by the **Principal, Dr. Ravi JD Saldanha,** who welcomed the dignitaries to the stage. The event was presided over by **Most Rev. Dr. Bernard Moras,** Apostolic Administrator, who emphasized the role of Artificial Intelligence in media and reiterated the significance of social communication, stating, "Social communication is for everything, pouring the grains into the pot."

The conference was formally inaugurated by **Dr. D.V. Guruprasad, former Director General of Police and former Director of the Karnataka Information Department.** He also released the Conference Book of Abstracts. In his address, he highlighted the differences between new media and print media, emphasizing the transformative impact of digital platforms on news creation and dissemination.

The keynote address was delivered by **Prof. Srinivas Melkote, Professor Emeritus at Bowling Green State University, USA.** He elaborated on innovations in media and technology, discussing the rewards and challenges associated with emerging communication trends. He also shared insights into contemporary research methodologies, offering valuable guidance to scholars and researchers.

The conference witnessed an impressive participation of **150 delegates, with 150 research papers presented, including 112 offline and online presentations. A total of 150 registrations and abstract** submissions reflected the enthusiasm and scholarly engagement of the participants.

The event concluded with a formal vote of thanks delivered by **Dr.Vagdevi H.S**, Assistant Professor, Department of Journalism, expressing gratitude to the dignitaries, participants, and organizers for making the conference a resounding success. The international conference provided a dynamic platform for knowledge exchange, fostering discussions on the future of communication in a rapidly changing world.
runs smoothly.



The International conference on ' Reimagining Communication in the 21st century: Sociological, Political and Economic Perspectives' has opened the doors for many concepts like - Is content a filler, does suturing content a necessity, are media engaging in disruptive mechanism, will media help in maintaining world order, will the relationship between content and learning strengthen etc. The panellists hailing from Universities across the globe discussing various allied topics threw light on digital inclusion and economic development, role of media in public good and commercial interest, future consumers of AI, skilling up students with digital content, content narrative etc. The conference gave a good exposure to the students of not only Journalism and Mass Communication but also student's community on the whole. It's a wonderful initiative by the Department of Journalism and Mass Communication.

MESSAGE
Rev.Fr.Gnana Pragasam
Campus Administrator
St. Philomena's College Institutions



I am thrilled that our Philomena's Autonomous College, PG Department of Journalism and Mass Communication, has organized a two-day international conference on Reimagining Communication in the 21st Century: Sociological, Political, and Economic Perspectives. Communication plays a vital role in our daily lives, facilitating smooth interactions and connections among people.

Digital communication, in particular, has redefined traditional notions of relationships, intimacy, and community. We live in an era where the internet and electronic media have made communication effortlessly accessible. As the world evolves, communication must also adapt, and it is crucial that we use it with positive intentions.

I extend my best wishes to all the students from around the world and everyone present here today. May you embrace the insights shared during this conference in a positive and constructive manner.

MESSAGE
Mr.Ronald Prakash Cutinha
VICE- PRINCIPAL{Administration}
St. Philomena's College Institutions



In the 21st century, the way people communicate has undergone a tremendous transformation, largely driven by digital technology. The facets of digital information, communication and technology is more critical than ever before, affecting how we connect, build relationships and convey our thoughts and ideas.

To be successful in the digital landscape, one must adapt to various communication forms, master the art of effective interaction and always remember the importance of clarity, empathy and respect in this new world of connectivity.

I am sure this international conference will dwell in detail about these perspectives and enlighten the participants.

Panel Session I

Media in Contemporary Political Settings: The Role of Media in Political Polarization

As part of the International Conference on Reimagining Communication: Sociological, Political, and Economic Perspectives, the first panel discussion focused on the role of media in political polarization.

Moderator Professor Vinod Pavarala introduced the session by emphasizing that democracy encompasses both voting and discussion. He posed a thought-provoking question: Does social media foster diverse opinions or reinforce ideological bubbles?

Dr. Shashidhar Nanjundaiah spoke about the inhibitory nature of media, the growing public distrust, and how political shifts often transition from democracy to autocracy.

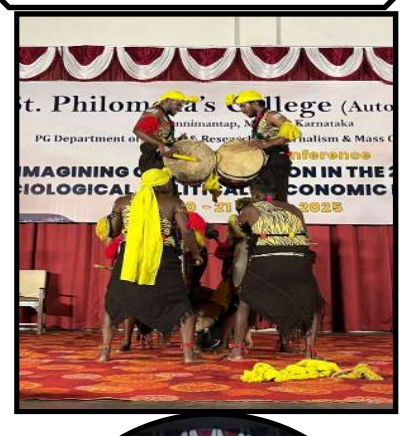
Dr. Ujjwal Chowdhury discussed the evolution of media from print to digital platforms, highlighting the prevalence of misinformation and the role of algorithms in shaping public perception. He underscored how virality often takes precedence over truth.

Dr. Satish Kolluri addressed issues of voter suppression and the broader impacts of polarization, while Dr. Asha Krishnaswamy linked media distrust to election-driven polarization and the rise of AI-generated content.





Cultural Night
Dollu Kunitha Performance
Bharatanatya Performance
Violin Performance







Releasing Conference Book of Abstracts





MESSAGE
Mr.Nagaraj Urs M
VICE- PRINCIPAL {Academic}
St. Philomena's College Institutions



Communication in the 21st century has undergone a drastic transformation through the digital revolution and AI technology. "Reimagining Communication in the 21st Century," a two-day international conference, is crucial in this context. It provides a platform to explore the sociological, political, and economic dimensions of modern communication. By addressing topics such as media ethics, the role of AI, and digital inclusion, the conference aims to foster a deeper understanding of how communication can be harnessed for positive societal impact.

MESSAGE
Dr. Shashidhar Nanjundaiah
Professor and Dean
School of Digital Media and Communication
Mahindra University, Hyderabad



A new intervening factor has emerged in the relationship between politics, media, and democracy—the factor of public distress. This distress is not limited to the media but extends to institutions across our democracy. Our panel will delve into this complex relationship between politics and media, exploring its implications and challenges.

MESSAGE
Prof. Usha Raman
Professor, Department of Communication
University of Hyderabad



I am truly looking forward to being a part of the upcoming conference, where we will discuss the role of communication and media in the 21st century. My panel, which will focus on media economics in the 21st century, will address some critical questions, including whether digital technology has enabled inclusion and greater equality through platform economies. We will also examine the emerging patterns of media ownership and their implications.

MESSAGE

Dr. Noor Mubasheer C.A
PG Coordinator
PG studies and Research centre
St. Philomena's College Institutions



Eagerly awaiting the mega event to be held on the 20th and 21st of March 2025 – a two-day international conference on "Reimagining Communication in the 21st Century: Sociological, Political, and Economic Perspectives." This conference serves as a platform to explore innovative ideas and redefine how we connect and share knowledge globally.
Looking forward to seeing you all there on the 20th of March 2025!

MESSAGE

Prof. B.P. Sanjay
Senior Professor, Communication and Media Studies
MIC, MAHE, Manipal



The conference theme, "Reimagining Communication in the 21st Century," is a crossroads theme that is both timely and relevant. The ecosystem in India has undergone considerable changes, profoundly impacting the sociological, political, and economic dynamics of our society. This platform offers an excellent opportunity to deliberate on these transformations and their implications for communication in the modern world.

MESSAGE

Prof. Usharani Narayana
Former Professor and Director
University of Mysore



Dear Friends,
I am delighted to share that I will be participating in the two-day international conference hosted by St. Philomena's College, Mysore, on the 20th and 21st of March this year. The theme of the conference, "Reimagining Communication in the 21st Century," is both timely and significant. It will delve into critical issues from sociological, political, and economic perspectives, offering a platform for meaningful discussions and innovative ideas.

Panel Session II

Media Economics in the 21st Century: Digital Inclusion and Economic Development

The second panel session of the ICRC at St. Philomena's College began at 3:00 PM in the indoor stadium, following a brief lunch break. The session was moderated by Prof. Usha Raman from the University of Hyderabad, who opened the discussion by highlighting the economic implications of media.
Panelist Dr. Shashidhar Nanjundaiah spoke about media prosumers as economic factors, illustrating his points with various real-life examples. The session continued with Prof. Mira K. Desai from Mumbai, who introduced the concept of digital inclusion and economic development. She emphasized the role of media in driving change, beyond mere profit-making.
Next, Prof. Sundeep R. Muppidi from the University of Hartford, USA, shared his insights on how media can be viewed as a business and a government watchdog, rather than solely a social watchdog. He also discussed how digitalization is transforming economic models.
The highly informative session concluded with a dynamic discussion and an engaging question-and-answer session with the audience.





The conference has been very well organized, right from the registration process and abstract submission to the moment we arrived—they took care of everything efficiently. The students here have done an excellent job in managing the event.

So far, the dignitaries and speakers have provided valuable insights, and I am looking forward to learning even more in the upcoming sessions.



It's enriching. I must say that when I leave this conference, I will take with me a wealth of information and meaningful connections, which is fantastic. I feel really good and consider myself very fortunate to present my research paper tomorrow, titled Remembering the First of March.
Thank you!



I am currently working at Christ University as a lecturer. When the announcement about this international conference was made, we were genuinely surprised, especially upon seeing the panelists—all of whom have international standards and publications. We were amazed at how the management successfully organized such a grand event on this scale.
As a proud alumnus of St. Philomena's College, and having observed the institution's growth over the years, I can confidently say that both the management and the department have come a long way. It is truly inspiring to witness their progress. It's a great feeling to be here. Thank you!

MESSAGE

Rev.Fr.David Sagayaraj S
Assistant to Rector
St. Philomena's College Institutions



The moment we speak about communication, we often think of social media. However, communication is not just about social media—it is much more than that.
Life on earth without communication becomes lifeless. We communicate with people, with the world, and with God. Communication brings us together—not only like-minded individuals and not just to agree on ideas—but also to grow in our interpersonal and intrapersonal relationships, as well as in our understanding and wisdom of the world.
While reimagining the aspects of communication, let us not merely digitize it. Social media is just a platform that allows us to communicate and move faster. Our communication should inspire us to be agents of change and to create a positive impact in the world, making it a better place for everyone.

MESSAGE

Prof: Srinivas Melkote
Professor Emeritus
Bowling Green state University USA



This international conference is held on 20 and 21 march on the theme Reimagining communication in the 21 century: sociological, political, economic perspectives. It was an honour to be delivered the gain of address we had engaged meaningful discussions and dialogue on media role in shaping society, politics and technology at St Philomena's college (Autonomous) Mysore.
I look forward to engaging with experts, scholars, and participants from diverse backgrounds to explore how communication can shape a better future for society.
Hope to see you there!

Panel Session III

AI and Contemporary Media – Promises and Challenges of Harnessing AI in the Digital Landscape

The session began with the moderator, Professor Sundeep Mudippi, outlining a few guidelines for the panelists and introducing the topic of discussion.

The first speaker, Ms. Malavika Melkote, Director and AI & Analytics Industry Expert, emphasized the importance of AI in handling tasks that do not require human intervention. She highlighted how AI accelerates time-intensive processes and how rapidly AI innovation is advancing.

Next, Dr. Vandana Padnekar-Magal discussed the ideological challenges of AI, particularly the issue of disinformation in digital media. While acknowledging these concerns, she also underscored the opportunities that AI presents.

Following her, Dr. Arpan Yagnik addressed the environmental costs of AI, its limitations, and the paradox of human intelligence coexisting with AI.

Professor Usha Raman then spoke about the inevitability of AI integration and its impact on academia. She compared traditional education methods with the rise of generative AI tools like ChatGPT, stressing the need to preserve the essence of learning and teaching.

The final panelist, Professor Ujjwal Chowdhury, focused on the responsible and strategic use of AI, advocating for a synergy between human intelligence and AI tools. He highlighted how AI enhances audience engagement through personalization.

The session concluded with an interactive discussion, followed by a brief question-and-answer segment.

Panel Session IV

Media ethics in the Digital sphere: Ethics and regulation in the 21st century.

The fourth panel session commenced at 11 30 a.m in the indoor statidum of St Philomena's college. The panel included distinguished members from around the world. Prof. B P Sanjay, senior professor ,MAHE, moderated the session. The session began with Prof. Sanjay briefly describing how the digital spheres and spaces have promoted and perpertuated a sense of polarization and reinforced certain aspects of culture to the rest of the society.

He addressed the challenges of governance and media responsibility as well.

The session was then taken over by Prof. Mira K Desai , Mumbai, who shed light on the complexity of governance of the platforms for posting content, with vivid examples.

Next, Prof Niranjana Vanalli was asked to put forth his opinions. Prof Vanalli questioned the balance between ethics and the advancing technology. He emphasized the danger of people's increasing blind trust in media.

Prof Mohan Dutta began his talk by presenting slides on decolonizing media ethics. He discussed media and colonialism as well as neoliberal digital media structures.

The other panelist, Prof Usharani Narayana, then examined the court of law on media ethics with different examples across the world.

The insightful discussion came to an end with a question-and-answer session with the audience. All in all ,the session proved to be very informative and thought-provoking.



The Department of Journalism and Mass Communication at St. Philomena's College (Autonomous), Mysuru, successfully organized a two-day international conference titled "Re-imagining Communication in the 21st Century: Sociological, Political, and Economic Perspectives." This significant event brought together scholars, media professionals, and policymakers to explore the evolving dimensions of communication in a digitalized and interconnected world.

The 21st century is redefining communication, pushing the boundaries of media, politics, society, and economics. The conference addressed challenges such as misinformation, media ethics, political polarization, and financial fraud while highlighting the transformative power of communication in revolutionizing societal interactions, information access, and social change.

This conference served as a platform for interdisciplinary collaboration, fostering innovation and strategies for building a more informed, inclusive, and equitable digital society.

A Brief History of the Department

The Department of Journalism and Mass Communication has a rich legacy that began in 1996 under the leadership of **Dr. Sukanya, its first Head of the Department (HOD).** She served with unwavering dedication until **2021,** transforming the department into a hub for students worldwide.

Key Highlights of the Department's History

1996: Launch of BA Journalism and Mass Communication as core subjects for undergraduate students.

2011: Introduction of the B.Voc (Bachelor of Vocational Studies) program in Journalism and Mass Communication.

2013: Establishment of a Postgraduate course, making St. Philomena's College the first undergraduate institution under Mysore University to offer this program.

2015: Setup of a state-of-the-art TV studio, enhancing students' practical training.

2018: Establishment of a Research Centre to promote advanced academic and research activities.

Student-Centric Initiatives

The Media Club, operated by the department, plays a vital role in honing students' communication skills. Students gain hands-on experience in reporting, editing, and page layout by contributing to the departmental newsletter," **Philo's Bulletin"**. Additionally, the annual journalistic meet, "**Aaina"**, provides a platform for showcasing talent and fostering professional growth. The department actively collaborates with industry partners for internships, workshops, and guest lectures, further bridging the gap between academia and industry.

Current Faculty Members

Dr. Venugopal M. K.
Dr. Vagdevi H. S.
Dr. Yamuna B.
Mr. Raviraj I. V.
Mr. Ravithej S. P.
Mr. Sanju T. S.

The department's initiatives, combined with its commitment to academic excellence, continue to set benchmarks in media and communication education, making it a sought-after destination for aspiring media professionals.



Expressing Our Gratitude to

Rev. Dr. Lourdu Prasad Joseph
Rector
(St.Philomena's Educational Institutions)
Rev. Fr. Gnana Pragasam
Campus Administrator
Rev. Fr David Sagayaraj S
Assistant to Rector

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